

■ resolve~S.O.S.

If you don't need any of the data on the disk, you can use fdisk to remove the partitions that you have.

As you have already mentioned that the disk has been labelled as C C C C C, provide this label when fdisk asks you for it instead of your name. Remove and recreate the partition(s), format them and then reinstall Windows.

Windows

+ Slow shuttle

I have a Pentium-III PC with 20 GB HDD and 64 MB RAM running Windows 98. Of late, whenever I click on any of the desktop icons, it takes almost 15-20 seconds to open up and that's really annoying. What could be the problem? Is it due to bad memory?

Rohit Kale

Via e-mail

R It is quite unlikely that 'bad memory' is causing the problem. If there is a faulty RAM module installed, the PC will not boot at all. The delay could occur due to a number of reasons.

For example, a CD-ROM or floppy diskette already present in the drives can cause My Computer to open very slowly as it tries to access the removable drives.

It is quite possible that some anti-virus program or other such program is carrying out some validation process before allowing you to access the folders.

If you have a lot of programs installed or running, this could be especially slow.

Hardware

+ Display terror

I have a Samsung 14-inch monitor on a Celeron 300A machine with 32 MB RAM running Windows Me on a S3 Virge AGP card. Recently, I found that while starting the computer, the monitor doesn't start at all. There is also no activity of the hard disk or CPU.

After I try fiddling around with the cables connecting the monitor to the display card for about 15 minutes, it starts, and then even if I shift the cables or tug at it, there is no problem. However, the next day again the same problem occurs, though it doesn't happen if I am working on my computer for some time.

What could be the problem? Is it a loose connection or some problem with my display card?

Rupali

Via e-mail

R Often a blank screen at startup is mistaken for a display card problem. It can happen for a number of reasons that cause the computer to not boot at all, such as loose RAM, processor, IDE cables, display adapter, etc.

Usually such a problem can be diagnosed by the number of times the BIOS beeps at startup. For instance, more than one beep means some device is not connected correctly.

One by one, remove all connections from the motherboard and fit them back firmly. Also, check the BIOS settings. There should be a parameter for Init Display First

with the options PCI and AGP. Ensure that this is set to AGP.

A blank screen can also be a result of the power cable attached to the monitor. Simply removing and plugging it back to the monitor should solve that. Make sure that it doesn't stretch too much to reach the power outlet.

Especially during the monsoons, you can also have problems with the soldering inside the monitor due to moisture formation. Get a technician to have a look at it.

Windows

+ Shut on time

Even if I shutdown the system properly, using the Shutdown option, when I switch it back, it displays the message that Windows was not shutdown properly, and Scandisk starts again. How do I get rid of this?

M. Umesh

Via e-mail

R During the shutdown process, the contents of the virtual cache are written to the hard disk. You haven't mentioned which operating system is installed on your PC. Particularly with Windows 98 SE and Windows Me, if the disk is an IDE hard disk, data may be written to the hard disk's onboard cache, but not to the disk itself.

When this occurs, the data is lost from the cache when the computer is turned off. Hence, scandisk assumes that Windows did not shutdown correctly.

Applications

+ Virus scanner runs amok

I recently formatted and reinstalled all the software on my machine after I upgraded my hard disk. Since the McAfee virus scan signature files were quite old, I downloaded the latest patch and installed it. But after that, the problems started.

Whenever I was working, the 'Blue screen of death' popped up saying that there was a vxd error and the application has to be terminated.

The error message pointed to mcscan32 which is a McAfee file. So, I uninstalled and reinstalled the virus scanner, but the moment I updated the files, I started getting the errors again. Now, I have permanently disabled Viruscan and Vshield, but what could be the problem?

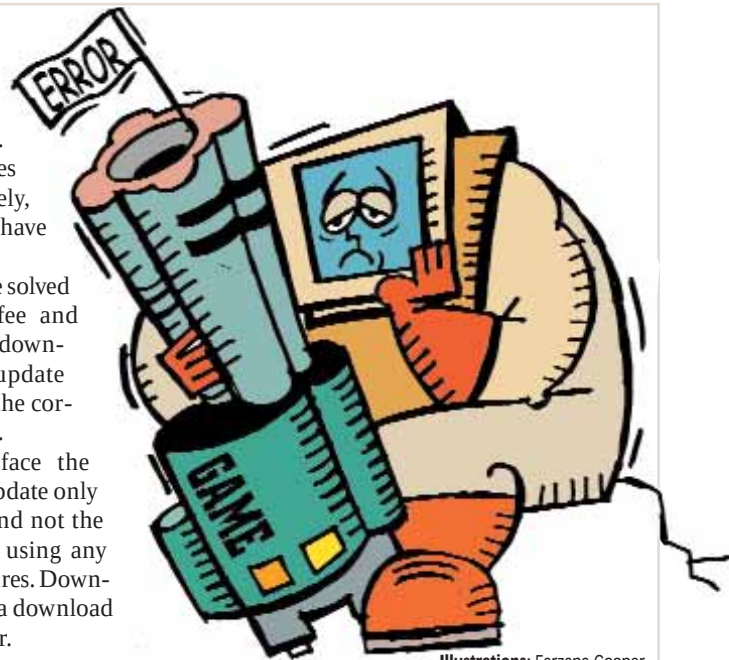
S Viswanathan

Via e-mail

R This is a very common error with McAfee software. Often, the update does not install completely, though it appears to have installed.

The problem can be solved by uninstalling McAfee and reinstalling it. You can download and install the update again (ensure it is for the correct operating system).

However, if you face the problem once more, update only the virus definitions and not the program itself. Avoid using any automatic update features. Download the updates from a download site; this is usually safer.



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